Table 49. Planning assumptions for the indicative budget

Item	Assumption	Basis
Exchange rate	Tk 124 per US dollar	Bangladesh Bank weighted average rate of Tk 123.65 on 19 October 2026 [110]
Core staff	9, 15 and 19 full-time equivalents in Years 1, 2 and 3	Staffing plan (Table 16)
Staff cost	Fully loaded monthly cost per FTE: Director Tk 3.0 lakh; ML and Bangla NLP engineers Tk 2.0 lakh; security engineer Tk 1.8 lakh; policy, data and platform staff Tk 1.5 lakh; governance and UX staff Tk 1.25 lakh; coordinator Tk 0.9 lakh; training officers Tk 0.8 lakh	Above the basic pay of the Ninth National Pay Scale 2026 (Tk 20,000 to Tk 156,000 per month) to compete for scarce AI skills [109]
Language editors and fellows	Part-time editors Tk 12 to 15 lakh per year; 6, 10 and 12 fellows at Tk 40,000 per month	Fellowship programme (Section 6.6)
Equipment	General-purpose servers USD 12,000 each; GPU inference servers (L40S class) USD 25,000 each; storage USD 6,000 to 8,000 per year of growth	Single L40S card about USD 7,500 in 2025, plus chassis, memory and storage [111]
Hosting and operations	Tk 25 lakh rising to Tk 45 lakh per year	Data-centre space, power, bandwidth, licences and a development cloud
Model adaptation compute	Provided in kind from shared national compute	Table 31; draft national AI policy [88]
Benchmark annotation	2,000 questions by month 30 at Tk 2,500 each, including adjudication	BanglaPolicyQA plan (Section 9.4, Annex K)
Training	500 officials by month 36 at Tk 15,000 per participant, plus specialist courses	Training curriculum (Table 18)
Evaluation and assurance	Mid-term evaluation Tk 20 lakh; final evaluation Tk 25 lakh; annual penetration test and red team	Chapters 13 and 18
Overheads and contingency	10% of all other costs	To be confirmed against the host institution's policy

Planning assumptions for the costing study (Deliverable D1.3), not quotations. The model is published as blueprint/src/budget_model.py so that any assumption can be changed and the budget regenerated.

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